

BEHAVIORAL PAIN SCALE (BPS)

Pain Assessment in Intubated, Sedated Critically Ill Adult Patients

1. PATIENT IDENTIFICATION

Patient Name: _____

Age / DOB: ____/____/____

MRN / ID: _____

Unit / Ward / Bed: _____

Surgery / Diagnosis: _____

Date / Time: ____/____/____ : ____

BEHAVIORAL DOMAINS

Clinical Parameter	Options & Scoring Criteria	Score
1. Facial Expression Muscle contraction and grimace	☐ Relaxed: Completely restful, neutral face (1) ☐ Partially tightened: Brow furrowing, tension (2) ☐ Fully tightened: Eye closure, deep grimacing (3) ☐ Grimacing: Distorted face, clenched jaw, tears (4)	[]
2. Upper Limbs Movement Posture and defensive movements	☐ No movement: Relaxed arms in neutral position (1) ☐ Partially bent: Slight elbow or finger flexion (2) ☐ Fully bent with finger flexion: Defense posture (3) ☐ Permanently retracted: Rigid limb flexion and resistance (4)	[]
3. Compliance with Ventilation Patient-ventilator synchrony	☐ Tolerating movement: No alarm, synchronized breathing (1) ☐ Coughing but tolerating ventilation: Coughs, settles spontaneously (2) ☐ Fighting ventilator: Dyssynchrony, alarms triggered frequently (3) ☐ Unable to control ventilation: Patient fighting ventilator continuously (4)	[]

ICU Analgesia & Sedation Titration Guideline: Evaluate BPS prior to painful procedures (suctioning, wound dressing, turning) and 15-30 min post-intervention. Target score in critical care: BPS ≤ 5. If BPS ≥ 6, initiate multimodal analgesia / opioid titration before escalating sedatives.

TOTAL SCORE: [] POINTS (Maximum: 12 points (3 to 12))**Assessor (RN / License #):** _____**CLINICAL INTERPRETATION & RECOMMENDED NURSING ACTIONS****No Pain / Acceptable (3 - 5 points)**

Adequate comfort and analgesia. Maintain current sedation/analgesic regimen.

Mild to Moderate Pain (6 - 7 points)

Assess patient; provide non-pharmacological comfort or analgesia titration.

Severe Pain / Discomfort (≥ 8 points)

Immediate analgesic intervention required (IV opioid bolus/titration). Reevaluate in 15-30m.

Registered Nurse (RN) Signature & Professional Stamp

Date & Time of Assessment